taken, for whatever reason, to allow the IB too to have direct access to some of those liaison contacts.

The foreign hand

It was the middle of November 1983 and I had not yet handed over charge of my two sensitive divisions. Gary Saxena told me that Kao wanted to meet the MI6 (UK's foreign intelligence agency) representative from the British High Commission. I picked up my MI6 contact and took him to Kao's office on the ground floor of the office block of the cabinet secretary, in the southern wing of Rashtrapati Bhavan.

Kao, after I introduced the contact to him, asked me to wait in the room of the officer on special duty Ratnakar Rao. The meeting lasted for about half an hour. I wondered what could have been the reason for Kao to ask me to keep away from the meeting. Due to some Op-2 related work that Kao was doing at that time, it seemed as if he was discussing something about Punjab. Just a month previously, on my return from New York, I had expressed to Gary Saxena my reservations on the way the situation in Punjab was being handled, or rather, mishandled. Perhaps Kao, who must have been in the know of that, did not want me at the meeting with the MI6 representative. Incidentally, on my return to office I informed Gary Saxena of Kao meeting my liaison contact alone, to which he did not react. Soon afterwards, I handed over charge of the liaison division to my successor.

B. Raman, in his book *Kaoboys of R&AW,* published in 2007 writes that two MI5 (typo for MI6; the MI5, UK's domestic intelligence agency, did not have any declared representative in New Delhi at that time) intelligence liaison officials at the British High Commission had scouted the Golden Temple complex in December 1983. [1] Most likely, their visit had resulted from Kao's meeting in November 1983 with my MI6 liaison contact, and he might have been one of the two officers who visited the Golden Temple complex.

The real purpose of that visit became clear when Phil Miller, an independent researcher and journalist, went to the British National